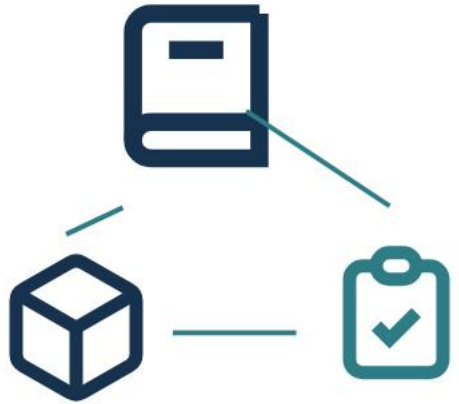
Yangyang Xiao | z5707699 | COMM5030 | Assessment 2

Beyond Toy Counts



Measuring Families' Access to Play Resources

A short-survey framework for Joy of Giving

Proposed measurement design | family-reported access

Evidence roles and appraisal criteria

Desk-based design appraisal | no participant data

Evidence roles

Domain: Toy Libraries Australia (2024)

Testing: ONS (n.d.), §§3–4

Measurement: World Bank (2021)

Administration: GDS (n.d.a–c)

Sector, methods and interface evidence support different design decisions.

Appraisal criteria

Relevance

Does it measure reported access change?

Burden

Recall, contacts and response effort

Feasibility

Available data, linkage and A3 time

Interpretation

Which claim can the design support?

Scope: proposed items have not been validated in Joy of Giving. Source roles are distinguished in the review and comparison.

Separate the outcome from its evidence

Desired change and measurement evidence are different

ACTIVITY

Toy redistribution

→

OUTPUT

Items received

→

INTENDED OUTCOME

Improved access to suitable play resources

MEASUREMENT EVIDENCE

Family-reported access change (Q1)

Satisfaction describes service experience; item counts describe output.

Proposed logic model. Course framework: Nguyen 2026b, pp.25–31. Child development remains outside scope.

Evidence informs indicator selection

Sector evidence changes which questions are retained

Concept	Evidence / rationale	Design choice / boundary
Availability	TLA: wider choice; uneven service access	Q1 overall change; no separate availability item
Affordability	TLA: saving money is a joining motive	Retain Q2 cost context; no cost-change estimate
Suitability	TLA names developmentally appropriate toys	Retain Q3 perceived fit with this child's needs
Use / constraints	Systems lens: receipt may not mean use	Q4 use; Q5 changes and barriers

TLA is a sector submission about lending; redistribution needs local testing.

These candidate concepts and item roles do not form a validated three-dimensional scale.

Sources: Toy Libraries Australia 2024, pp.2–3; Nguyen 2026c. Question selection is the author's judgement.

Measurement options and design choice

Option	Relevance	Burden	Feasibility	Interpretation
Records	Indirect: activity	Low if existing	If usable records	Reach and output
Satisfaction	Service experience	Low	One contact	Positive ≠ access change
Retrospective Q1 + context	Closer to outcome	Recall + five items	If eligible 4-week contact	Perceived change; recall risk
Baseline + follow-up	Prospective change	Two waves; linkage	If data and timing fit	Less recall of change; attrition remains

Choose Q1 + context if one eligible follow-up fits the A3 timetable.

Prefer baseline + follow-up if feasible; otherwise audit existing questions/data.

Qualitative author appraisal; no measured ratings. Method basis: Bjarkefur et al. 2021; ONS n.d., §7 and Annex 2.

One main indicator; four supporting items

Q1 **Reported access change**
Primary outcome indicator

Q2 **Cost barriers**
Context; no cost-change estimate

Q3 **Perceived suitability**
Context; fit of received items

Q4 **Recent use**
Context; zero–seven days

Q5 **Open explanation**
What changed; what helped or hindered?

Report separately

Show each category and its valid item count.

Keep uncertain and skipped answers distinct.

No total access score.

Full wording: Appendix A; item-specific interpretation: Appendix B. Administration details remain in reading notes.

Match each claim to the study design

Reported change does not establish programme effects.

Threat / condition	Reporting safeguard
Recall	State the before/after reference periods.
Selective response	Say “among responding families”; retain uncertainty.
Without an adequate comparison	Do not attribute reported change to the programme.

Records and interviews can support interpretation; design still limits attribution.

Counterfactual reasoning: Bjarkefur et al. 2021, ch.3. Recall/response considerations: A1 and Nguyen 2026a.

Testing plan and A3 feasibility

01

Check feasibility

Client/Tutor: arrange carer access; confirm contact route, baseline/linkage and A3 cut-off.

02

Probe understanding

Student: probe meanings, recall windows and answer choices with 3–5 adult carers (proposed); log confusion.

03

Revise and recheck

Student + team: clarify terms, add missing options, remove nonessential items and recheck changes.

If digital: UX walkthrough checks completion, navigation and understanding.

Log missing options and time. Proposed form target: ≤3 minutes, excluding interview probes.

Four-week follow-up only if eligible past visits, contact access and A3 timing allow.

If a new wait leaves too little analysis/writing time, or the client survey is fixed:
Audit existing items/data → interpret results → recommend next-cycle improvements.

Testing: ONS n.d., §3 Table 1, §4 and Annex 2; Bjarkefur et al. 2021. Roles, numbers and target time are proposals.

References | domain and methods

Toy Libraries Australia (2024)

Opportunities in the circular economy: Productivity Commission submission.

Submission 130, November, pp.1–3. Supplied PDF; industry submission reporting sector evidence.

Office for National Statistics (ONS) (n.d.)

Question and questionnaire development overview for Census 2021.

§§3–4, §7 and Annex 2. Supplied converted reading copy, pp.4, 7, 14, 18–19; viewed 19 October 2026.

Bjarkefur, K., de Andrade, L.C., Daniels, B. and Jones, M.R. (2021)

Development Research in Practice: The DIME Analytics Data Handbook.

World Bank, chs.3–4, source version viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/worldbank/dime-data-handbook

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.a)

Question pages. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

References | design and course context

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.b)

Radios. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.c)

Check answers. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

Nguyen, L. (2026a)

Week 2: Action Research & Data Collection.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture guide, pp.18–19 and 29–30. Supplied course material.

Nguyen, L. (2026b)

Week 3: Social Impact Measurement.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture slides, pp.25–31 and 42. Supplied course material.

Nguyen, L. (2026c)

Week 5: Systems Thinking.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture slides, pp.17–28. Supplied course material.

Preparation: ChatGPT assisted drafting; Image Gen informed style A; PPT Master supported editable export.

Appendix A | draft parent survey

For adult carers. Proposed four-week follow-up, if feasible. Show the selected visit date; answer for one child. No child identifier. Participation is optional and does not affect support.

1. Access change

Compared with the four weeks before that visit, how easy was it to obtain suitable toys or books for this child in the four weeks after it?

Much harder; a little harder; no change; a little easier; much easier; not sure.

2. Cost barrier

In the four weeks after that visit, how often did cost prevent you getting toys or books this child needed?

Never; sometimes; often; always; not sure; prefer not to answer.

3. Suitability

How suitable were the items received for this child's play needs?

Not at all; slightly; moderately; very; extremely; not sure; not used yet.

4. Recent use

In the last seven days, on how many days did this child use an item from that visit?

Zero to seven days; not sure.

5. Explanation (optional)

What, if anything, changed in this child's access? What helped or made access difficult?

Author-drafted items. Test wording, periods and options. Methods: ONS n.d., §§3–4; administration: GDS n.d.a–c.

Appendix B | indicator and reporting guide

Use item-specific valid n; show unsure/skipped counts separately. No total score.

Item / role	Reporting rule	Interpretation boundary
Q1 | Primary change	Report each change category and valid item count.	Reported change; causality not established.
Q2 | Cost context	Report frequency categories for the stated period.	Current barrier, not evidence of cost reduction.
Q3 | Fit context	Report the distribution of perceived-fit ratings.	Suitability, not child development.
Q4 | Use context	Report zero–seven days; show unknown separately.	Recent use, not an access-change measure.
Q5 | Explanation	Code themes; use anonymised examples.	Explains experiences, not prevalence.

Author's proposed reporting protocol. Unknown, skipped and no-change answers remain distinct. No composite scale is claimed.